



February 26, 2026

JAMES FORREST GRANT
2323 OVERTON RD
AUGUSTA GA 30904-3445

We made a decision on your VA benefits.

Dear James Grant:

This letter will guide you through the information you should know and steps you may take now that VA has made a decision about your benefits.

VA completed your request for higher-level review and identified an error in assisting you in gathering evidence to support your claim in each of your claimed conditions. VA will provide you notification of the evidence we will obtain to address these errors under a separate cover.

Your Benefit Information:

- A duty to assist error has been identified during the higher-level review for individual unemployability.

See **Rating Decision** to find out why we made this decision.

As a Veteran with a service-connected disability, you may be eligible for up to \$40,000 in VA life insurance benefits. Veterans Affairs Life Insurance (VALife) is guaranteed acceptance whole life insurance available to all service-connected, disabled veterans with no time limit to apply as long as you are age 80 or under. Veterans age 81 and over are still eligible in certain circumstances. Visit the VALife Insurance website, <https://www.va.gov/life-insurance/options-eligibility/valife/>, for further information.

No changes have been made to your past or current payment rates. The payment chart provided is historical information for your reference only.

Your monthly entitlement amount is shown below:

We have included with this letter:

1. Explanation of Payment
2. Additional Benefits
3. Where to Send Your Correspondence
4. Rating Decision
5. Fraud Prevention Attachment

Contact information:

Web: www.va.gov
Phone: 1-800-827-1000
TDD: 711
To send questions online: visit <https://ask.va.gov/>

Social Media:

Twitter: @VAVetBenefits
Facebook: www.facebook.com/VeteransBenefits

How to obtain representation:

We have no record of you appointing an accredited representative. Accredited representatives are trained to help you understand and apply for VA benefits. For more information about how an accredited representative can help you, please visit: <https://www.vets.gov/disability-benefits/apply-for-benefits/help/>

If you or someone you know is in crisis, call the *Veterans Crisis Line* by dialing 988 and then pressing 1.



Monthly Entitlement Amount	Payment Start Date	Reason
\$144.14	Dec 1, 2020	Original Award
\$152.64	Dec 1, 2021	Cost of Living Adjustment
\$165.92	Dec 1, 2022	Cost of Living Adjustment
\$171.23	Dec 1, 2023	Cost of Living Adjustment
\$175.51	Dec 1, 2024	Cost of Living Adjustment
\$1,759.19	Jan 1, 2025	Compensation Rating Adjustment
\$2,044.89	Nov 1, 2025	Compensation Rating Adjustment
\$2,102.15	Dec 1, 2025	Cost of Living Adjustment

We are currently paying you as a single Veteran with no dependents.

If payments are due, you should receive your first payment, if not already in receipt of payments, within 7-10 days of this notice.

See **Explanation of Payment** for more details about your payment.

Your payment will be directed to the financial institution and account number that you specified. To confirm when your payment was deposited, please contact your financial institution.

If this account is no longer open,

please notify us immediately.

Thank you for your service,

Regional Office Director



Explanation of Payment

We are currently paying you as a single Veteran with no dependents.

Please Take Action: What Things Affect Your Right to Payment?

Please notify VA ***immediately*** if there is a change in any condition affecting your right to continued payments. If you don't notify us of these changes immediately, you may have to return any overpayments. Those changes include:

Evidence received shows a change is warranted.
Military Pay or Worker's Compensation: Your payments may be affected by the following, which you must bring to our attention: • Reentrance into active military or naval service. • Receipt of armed forces service retirement pay, unless your retirement pay has already been reduced because of award of disability compensation. • Receipt of benefits from the Office of Federal Employees Compensation. • Receipt of active duty or drill pay as a reservist or member of the National Guard.
Dependents: If you have a disability rating of 30 percent or more, you must advise VA of any change with your spouse or children.
Hospitalization: If your award includes Aid and Attendance benefits, we may reduce this additional allowance if you are admitted to a hospital, nursing home, or domiciliary care at VA expense.
Incarceration: Benefits will be reduced if you are incarcerated in a federal, state, or local penal institution for more than 60 days for conviction of a felony.
Lack of Cooperation: We may stop monthly payments if you: • fail to submit evidence we requested, • fail to attend a VA examination when requested, or • Submit false or fraudulent evidence to VA, or cause false or fraudulent evidence to be submitted to VA.
Fraud/Lying to Government: The law provides severe penalties, which include fines, imprisonment, or both, for the fraudulent acceptance of any payment to which you are not entitled. We may verify information you submit through computer-matching programs with other agencies.

Additional Benefits

Education, Training, and Employment: • <u>Education loans</u>: For more information, please call 1-888-GIBILL-1 (1-888-442-4551) or
--



visit www.vets.gov/education.

- Veterans with student loans: For more information, please call 1-888-303-7818 or visit www.disabilitydischarge.com/.

Medical Care and Treatment:

- Mental Health Counseling: For more information, please visit www.myhealth.va.gov/mhv-portal-web/.
- Blind Rehabilitation: For more information, please visit www.va.gov/blindrehab/.

Home Adaptations/Loans, Automobile Benefits, and Life Insurance:

- Loans: For more information, please visit www.benefits.va.gov/homeloans/.
- Funding Fee Refund: If you paid a funding fee at the closing of a VA guaranteed home loan and your VA compensation award provides an effective rating date that was prior to your loan closing date, then you may be eligible for a funding fee refund. Please contact either your current mortgage servicer or a VA Regional Loan Center at (877) 827-3702 to begin the refund process.
- Government life insurance: As a Veteran with a service-connected disability, you may be eligible for up to \$40,000 in VA life insurance benefits. Veterans Affairs Life Insurance (VALife) is guaranteed acceptance whole life insurance available to all service-connected, disabled veterans with no time limit to apply as long as you are age 80 or under. Veterans age 81 and over are still eligible in certain circumstances. For more information on VALife, please visit <https://www.va.gov/life-insurance/options-eligibility/valife/>.

Armed Forces Commissary and Exchange:

- You may be entitled to Armed Forces Commissary and Exchange privileges. Honorably discharged Veterans with a service-connected disability; Former Prisoners of War; Purple Heart or Medal of Honor recipients; military retirees; members of the reserves; and their dependents may qualify for entitlement to this additional benefit. For more information, please visit va.gov/resources/commissary-and-exchange-privileges-for-veterans.

Veterans Signals (VSignals), a VA Customer Experience Survey

VA is conducting short surveys to gather feedback regarding the new decision review process. VA will randomly select survey participants from individuals who filed a request for a decision review. The survey will be sent via email and should take less than three minutes to complete. If selected, you will receive a survey within 10 days of the date on your notification letter. To be considered for VA surveys, please review your va.gov profile and ensure we have your current email address. The survey may not route to your inbox, so please check your junk folder.



Where to Send Your Correspondence

Documents may be submitted by mail, in person at a VA regional office or electronically. However, VA recommends submitting correspondence electronically as this is the fastest method of receipt.

VA provides several tools to assist in electronic submission. To learn more about how to submit documents and claims electronically, visit www.va.gov/disability/upload-supporting-evidence. You can also go directly to AccessVA (<https://eauth.va.gov/accessva/?cspselectfor=quicksubmit>) to digitally upload any correspondence using QuickSubmit.

By visiting www.va.gov you can also check your claim status and learn about other VA benefits.

If you need assistance, you can find a local, accredited representative at <https://www.benefits.va.gov/vso/>.

If you prefer to mail your correspondence, please use the related mailing address below:

Compensation Benefits	Pension & Survivors Benefits
Department of Veterans Affairs Compensation Intake Center P.O. Box 4444 Janesville, WI 53547 Toll Free Phone: 1-800-827-1000 Toll Free Fax: (844) 531-7818	Department of Veterans Affairs Pension Intake Center P.O. Box 5365 Janesville, WI 53547 Toll Free Phone: 1-800-827-1000 Toll Free Fax: (844) 655-1604
Board of Veterans' Appeals	Fiduciary
Department of Veterans Affairs Board of Veterans' Appeals P.O. Box 27063 Washington, DC 20038 Toll Free Fax: (844) 678-8979	Department of Veterans Affairs Fiduciary Intake Center P.O. Box 5211 Janesville, WI 53547 Toll Free Phone: 1-800-827-1000 Toll Free Fax: (888) 581-6826

These addresses serve **all United States**
and foreign locations.

 Veterans Crisis Line DIAL 988 then PRESS 1	Veteran Crisis Line Dial 988 then Press 1 You can also send a text message to 838255 to receive confidential support 24 hours a day, 7 days a week, 365 days a year. For more information, visit www.veteranscrisisline.net
---	--



**DEPARTMENT OF VETERANS AFFAIRS
Veterans Benefits Administration
Decision Review Operations Center**

JAMES GRANT

**VA File Number
253 29 5114**

**Rating Decision
02/25/2026**

INTRODUCTION

The records reflect that you are a Veteran of the Gulf War Era and Peacetime. You served in the Army from October 25, 1988 to October 24, 1992. We received your request for a Higher Level Review on December 14, 2025. Based on a review of the evidence listed below, we have made the following decision(s) on your claim.

Please note: The evidentiary record closed on the date of notice of our prior decision. VA received additional evidence, which was not part of that decision after the record closed. If you would like VA to consider this evidence, you may submit a supplemental claim at any time; however, VA must receive your application within one year of the date of notice of this decision to preserve your right to receive the maximum possible benefit.

DECISION

A duty to assist error has been identified during the higher-level review for individual unemployability.

EVIDENCE

- Previous rating decision received Nov 18, 2025



- VA form 21-8940 received Dec 01, 2025
- VA form 21-8940 received Oct 16, 2025
- Buddy / lay statement gout received Oct 15, 2025
- VA Form 21-526 EZ : Application for Disability Compensation and Related Compensation Benefits, received Oct 15, 2025
- VA21-8940 veterans application for increased compensation based on unemployability exam Oct 16, 2025
- VA Form 21-526 EZ : Application for Disability Compensation and Related Compensation Benefits, received Oct 23, 2025
- Disability Benefit Questionnaire kidney exam Nov 03, 2025
- Disability Benefit Questionnaire medical opinion sinusitis exam Nov 03, 2025
- Disability Benefit Questionnaire skin diseases exam Nov 03, 2025
- Disability Benefit Questionnaire kidney conditions exam Nov 03, 2025
- Disability Benefit Questionnaire sinusitis/rhinitis and other conditions exam Nov 03, 2025
- Disability Benefit Questionnaire Skin Diseases medical opinion Nov 03, 2025
- Disability Benefit Questionnaire medical opinion GU Kidney exam Nov 03, 2025
- CAPRI medical records Augusta VAMC June 11, 2010- Nov 17, 2025
- Rating Decision, dated December 11, 2025
- VA letter, dated December 12, 2025
- VA Form 20-0996, Decision Review Request - Higher Level Review, received December 14, 2025
- HLR Informal Conference, February 23, 2026

REASONS FOR DECISION

Higher Level Review for individual unemployability.

The issue of individual unemployability was returned for correction of a duty to assist error in the prior decision. We failed to get an examination(s) and/or medical opinion(s). We will develop for VA exam.

Favorable Findings identified in this decision:

You are not working. VA Form 21-8940, shows you are currently not working.

Your service-connected disabilities meet the schedular criteria for entitlement to individual unemployability. You currently meet the schedular for IU.

Laws and regulations applicable to this issue:

38 CFR § 3.321 General Rating Considerations
38 C.F.R. §3.1 Definitions.
38 C.F.R. §3.159 Department of Veterans Affairs assistance in developing claims.
38 C.F.R. §4.1 Essentials of evaluative rating.
38 C.F.R. §4.7 Higher of two evaluations.



JAMES GRANT
253 29 5114
3 of 3

38 C.F.R. §4.10 Functional impairment.
38 CFR §4.2 Interpretation of examination reports
38 CFR §4.3 Resolution of reasonable doubt.
38 CFR §4.6 Evaluation of evidence.
38 CFR §3.102 Reasonable doubt.
38 CFR § 3.321(b)1 Extra Schedular Consideration
38 CFR § 3.340 Total and Permanent Total Rating and Unemployables
38 CFR § 4.15 Total Disabling Rating
38 CFR § 4.16 Total Disabling Rating Based on IU
38 CFR § 4.18 Unemployability
38 CFR § 4.19 Age in service-connected claims

REFERENCES:

Title 38 of the Code of Federal Regulations, Pensions, Bonuses and Veterans' Relief contains the regulations of the Department of Veterans Affairs which govern entitlement to all Veteran benefits. For additional information regarding applicable laws and regulations, please consult your local library, or visit us at our website, www.va.gov.



Fraud Prevention: Protect Your Benefits

Please contact the VA ***immediately*** at 1-800-827-1000 if you suspect your information is compromised.

- You receive correspondence from VA concerning a claim, and you don't remember filing a claim contact the VA at 1-800-827-1000.
- You receive correspondence requesting a processing fee prior to releasing benefit payments contact the VA at 1-800-827-1000.
- VA may check in with you by phone, email, or text message. The VA will **never ask for personal information via email**. This includes verification of your SSN, address, and/or bank information. If you are unsure about any call, email, or text, confirm details directly with the VA.
- VA **does not threaten** claimants with jail or lawsuits.
- Be cautious of telephone numbers on caller ID. Scammers may change the telephone number (spoofing) to make a call appear to come from a different person or place.
- When in doubt, hang up and call VA directly at 1-800-827-1000, or call your Power of Attorney representative (DAV, VFW, etc.).
- **Do not ignore emails or letters** from the VA notifying you of an update to direct deposit or eBenefits account information. If you don't remember making changes, it could be the first sign your information was compromised.
- Use secure, unique passwords, and two factor identification where available. To establish a more secure logon for Vets.gov and ebenefits.va.gov with two factor identification create an account via ID.me at <https://api.id.me/en/registration/new>
- Monitor your accounts regularly, respond to fraud alerts and report unauthorized transactions promptly.
- To learn more about protecting yourself from fraud, and how to report it visit <https://www.va.gov/oig/hotline/default.asp>, or go to VA.gov and search "Office of Inspector General".
- For more details on how to avoid scams go to <https://www.fcc.gov/veterans-targeted-benefits-scams>
- Download free financial scam awareness resources at <https://www.consumerfinance.gov/about-us/blog/helping-prevent-scams-targeted-veterans/>
- Get up-to-date information on fraud and scams from the Federal Trade Commission <https://public.tableau.com/profile/federal.trade.commission>